I'm not looking for AI-automation theater.

What I actually want as a Python backend engineer — and what signals tell me I'll be useful.

10 slides · swipe

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Python reliability, not AI buzzwords.

Give me a backend with real users, a pipeline that breaks in boring ways, and a team that measures failure honestly. That's the entire pitch — no slide deck required.

Real users beat real resumes.

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The five signals I look for.

01 A broken pipeline I can map in my first week

02 Postmortems that name causes, not culprits

03 Tests that fail honestly, not green wallpaper

04 A codebase with debt someone admits to

05 Owning failures end-to-end — from page to fix

None of these require AI. All of these ship product.

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Two kinds of teams.

THEATER	ENGINEERING
AI automation theater	Reliability engineering
prompts as architecture	pipelines with owners
'make it autonomous'	metric-driven postmortems
no owner, no metrics	boring and proud of it

I ship the latter. I interview the latter. The former churns.

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What my last roles actually looked like.

6

services in the Minecraft network I rebuilt to survive

62

MCP tools in opencode-chrome, each traced to a real failure

5+

languages shipped in real projects: Python, TS, Java, Rust, Lua

Every number above traces to production work.

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What I walk in with on day one.

01 Failure mode instincts from too many 3 a.m. pages

02 Python + Go + C++ + a healthy paranoia about defaults

03 LLM integration that validates output, not vibes

04 Docs people read before the code, not after

I bring judgment. The rest I learn in your repo.

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What your broken pipeline is missing.

Most 'AI readiness' decks die at the CSV import step. The real work — idempotent writes, schema contracts, observable failures — is what I do at 9 a.m., not on stage.

CSV hell is where
AI maturity is actually decided.

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HIRING · WHAT I ASK · 8/10

What I need to say yes.

01 Real users on the thing, or a deadline for them

02 A failure review culture — blameless, documented

03 Autonomy over one real boundary, not ten demos

04 Honest stack — I can smell greenfield cosplay

Four boxes. If any is red, we'll both be unhappy.

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The ask.

Send me your hardest broken pipeline. I'll tell you if I can fix it — and how I'd know.

No deck. No 'synergy'. One whiteboard, one hour.

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HIRING · THE CLOSE · 10/10

Let's talk about your backlog.

If your Python backend or AI pipeline is one incident away from a rewrite, we should talk. antonpetnitsky.com — I reply within a day.

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